

STUCK

1. Passage anchor

> “Whenever a student got ****stuck****, she seemed to pull out exactly the right explanation.”

Passage meaning

****get stuck**** = become unable to continue because you do not know what to do, understand, or say next

****卡住；遇到困難；不知道怎麼繼續****

Here, the student is not physically trapped. The meaning is mental / problem-solving difficulty.

Practice

1. I got ****stuck**** on the last question.

我在最後一題****卡住了****。

2. Whenever we got ****stuck****, she explained the idea in a different way.

每當我們****卡住****時，她就會換一種方式解釋。

Core meanings of STUCK

2. stuck — unable to move

= fixed in one position and unable to move

****卡住的；動不了的****

Examples

1. The door is ****stuck****.

門****卡住了****。

2. My car got ****stuck**** in the mud.

我的車****陷在泥裡動不了****。

This is the central physical meaning.

3. get stuck

= become unable to move, continue, or make progress

****卡住；受阻****

Examples

1. The drawer ****got stuck**** halfway open.

抽屜拉到一半就****卡住了****。

2. We ****got stuck**** in traffic.

我們****被塞在車陣中****。

Mental / problem-solving difficulty

4. get stuck on something

= become unable to continue because something is difficult to understand or solve

****在.....卡住；被.....難住****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. I ****got stuck on**** a physics problem.

我在一道物理題上****卡住了****。

2. She ****got stuck on**** the final step.

她在最後一步****遇到了困難****。

5. be stuck for an answer / idea / word

= be unable to think of what to say or do

****想不出答案 / 主意 / 詞語****

Examples

1. I was ****stuck for an answer****.

我一時****想不出答案****。

2. He was ****stuck for words****.

他一時****說不出話來****。

Trapped in a place

6. stuck somewhere

= unable to leave a place or situation

被困在某處

Examples

1. We were **stuck at the airport** overnight.

我們整晚都**困在機場**。

2. She was **stuck in the lift** for twenty minutes.

她**被困在電梯裡**二十分鐘。

Traffic / delay

7. stuck in traffic

= unable to move because of heavy traffic

塞車；困在車陣中

Examples

1. Sorry I'm late—I was **stuck in traffic**.

抱歉我遲到了，我剛才**塞車**。

2. We were **stuck in traffic** for nearly an hour.

我們**被困在車陣中**將近一小時。

Very common fixed expression.

Fixed by glue / attachment

8. stuck to something

= attached firmly to a surface

黏在.....上

Examples

1. The label was **stuck to the box**.

標籤**黏在盒子上**。

2. Gum was **stuck to my shoe**.

口香糖**黏在我的鞋底**。

9. stuck together

= attached to each other and difficult to separate

黏在一起；卡在一起

Examples

1. The pages were **stuck together**.

這幾頁**黏在一起**了。

2. The two pieces were **stuck together** with glue.

兩塊東西用膠水**黏在一起**。

Unable to change situation

10. be stuck in a situation

= be unable to escape or change an unwanted situation

困在某種處境中；無法擺脫

Examples

1. He felt **stuck in a job he hated**.

他覺得自己**困在一份討厭的工作裡**。

2. She didn't want to stay **stuck in the same routine**.

她不想一直**困在同樣的生活模式裡**。

This is a major figurative extension.

11. feel stuck

= feel unable to make progress or change your situation

覺得卡住；覺得停滯不前

Examples

1. I felt ****stuck**** and didn't know what to do next.
我覺得自己****卡住了****，不知道下一步該怎麼辦。
2. Sometimes people feel ****stuck**** in their careers.
有時候人們會覺得自己的職涯****停滯不前****。

Forced to accept / unable to avoid

12. be stuck with something

= have to keep or deal with something unwanted because there is no alternative
****只好接受；不得不處理；甩不掉****

Examples

1. We're ****stuck with this old computer**** for now.
我們目前****只好繼續用這台舊電腦****。
2. She was ****stuck with the bill****.
最後變成她****不得不付帳****。

13. be stuck with someone

= be forced to spend time with or deal with someone
****不得不和某人在一起 / 應付某人****

Examples

1. I was ****stuck with him**** for the whole journey.
整段旅程我都****不得不和他待在一起****。
2. She was ****stuck with a difficult customer****.
她****只好應付一個難纏的顧客****。

Fixed on / unable to stop thinking

14. be stuck on something

= be unable to move beyond a particular idea, issue, or stage

一直卡在；執著於；停留在

Examples

1. We're still **stuck on the same problem**.

我們仍然**卡在**同一個問題上**。

2. He seems **stuck on one idea**.

他似乎一直**執著於**同一個想法**。

Expression / word recall

15. stuck for words

= unable to think of what to say

一時語塞；說不出話來

Examples

1. I was completely **stuck for words**.

我完全**說不出話來**。

2. Her question left me **stuck for words**.

她的問題讓我一時**語塞**。

Past participle family relation

16. stuck — past tense / past participle of stick

stuck is also the past tense and past participle of **stick**.

Examples

1. I **stuck** the note on the wall.

我把便條**貼在牆上**。

2. The note was **stuck** to the wall.

便條被**貼在牆上**。

Because **stick** is highly polysemous, it deserves separate curation if needed.

High-value expressions

17. get stuck on a question

= become unable to solve or answer a question

****在某題卡住****

Examples

1. Don't spend too long if you ****get stuck on a question****.

如果你****在某題卡住****，不要花太久時間。

2. I ****got stuck on question five****.

我在第五題****卡住了****。

18. get stuck in

In British English, ****get stuck in**** can also mean:

= start doing something enthusiastically and energetically

****積極投入；開始大幹一場****

Examples

1. Everyone ****got stuck in**** and helped clean the room.

大家都****積極投入****幫忙清理房間。

2. Let's ****get stuck in****.

我們****開始動手吧****。

This is completely different from “become trapped.”

19. stuck in a rut

= trapped in a boring, repetitive pattern of life or behavior

****陷入一成不變的生活；停滯不前****

Examples

1. I felt ****stuck in a rut****.

我覺得自己**陷入一成不變的生活**。

2. Changing jobs helped her get out of the rut she was **stuck in**.
換工作幫助她擺脫原本**停滯不前的生活模式**。

Key contrasts

20. stuck vs trapped

****stuck****

= unable to move or progress

****卡住；困住****

****trapped****

= unable to escape, often more serious or dangerous

****被困住；受困****

Compare:

> My car is **stuck in the mud**.

> 我的車陷在泥裡。

> The hikers were **trapped by the fire**.

> 登山客被大火困住。

****Trapped**** often sounds more severe.

21. stuck vs blocked

****blocked****

= passage, route, process, or access is prevented

****被堵住；受阻****

****stuck****

= the person or thing itself cannot move or progress

Compare:

> The road is **blocked**.

> 道路被堵住。

> We are **stuck** behind the accident.

> 我們被困在事故後方。

22. stuck vs confused

****confused****

= not understanding clearly

****困惑的****

****stuck****

= unable to continue or solve because of difficulty

Compare:

> I'm ****confused**** about the formula.

> 我不太明白這條公式。

> I'm ****stuck**** on the final calculation.

> 我在最後的計算步驟卡住了。

You can be confused without being completely stuck.

23. stuck vs lost

****lost****

can mean not knowing where you are or what to do

****迷路；不知所措****

****stuck****

emphasizes inability to move forward.

Compare:

> I felt ****lost**** at the beginning of the lesson.

> 我一開始上課時覺得很不知所措。

> I got ****stuck**** on the calculation.

> 我在計算部分卡住了。

Both appear naturally in the passage's learning context, but with different nuances.

24. stuck vs stalled

****stalled****

= stopped making progress, especially a process, project, negotiation, engine, etc.

****停滯；停頓****

****stuck****

= broader and more everyday

Compare:

> The project has ****stalled****.

> 專案停滯了。

> We're ****stuck**** and need a new approach.

> 我們卡住了，需要換個方法。

Meaning map

The central concept of ****stuck**** is:

****unable to move away from a position or move forward****

From this develop:

Physical

car stuck in mud

→ ****陷住 / 動不了****

Mechanical

door stuck

→ ****卡住****

Mental

stuck on a problem

→ ****解題卡住****

Location

stuck at the airport

→ ****被困在某處****

Situation

stuck in a bad job

→ **困在某種處境**

Obligation

stuck with the bill

→ **不得不承擔**

Speech

stuck for words

→ **語塞**

The passage uses the mental-progress branch:

a student cannot continue understanding or solving the problem

→ **the student gets stuck**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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stuck — unable to move	因被卡住、陷住或固定而無法移動
get stuck	變得無法移動、繼續或取得進展
get stuck on something	因某個問題太難而無法繼續理解、解答或完成
stuck for an answer/idea	一時想不出答案、主意或下一步
stuck somewhere	因交通、故障、事故等原因無法離開某處
stuck in traffic	因交通擠塞而無法前進；塞車
stuck to something	黏在某物表面，難以分開
stuck together	兩個或多個東西黏 / 卡在一起
stuck in a situation	處於一個不理想且難以改變或離開的處境
feel stuck	覺得自己無法取得進展或不知道下一步怎麼做
stuck with something	因沒有其他選擇而不得不保留、承擔或處理某事
stuck with someone	因情況所迫而不得不與某人相處或應付某人
stuck on something — figurative	一直停留在某個問題、想法或階段，無法向前
stuck for words	一時想不到該說什麼；語塞
get stuck in — BrE idiom	積極投入並開始做某事
stuck in a rut	陷入重複、無聊且難以改變的生活或工作模式

Passage recap

> “Whenever a student got **stuck**, she seemed to pull out exactly the right explanation.”

Here:

get stuck = **become unable to continue because you do not understand how to solve or understand something**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **卡住**

* **遇到困難**

* **不知道怎麼繼續**

* contextually: **每當學生在理解或解題時卡住**

Natural contextual translation:

每當學生卡住時，她總能拿出最合適的解釋。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

stuck

= **unable to make progress because you do not know how to continue**

卡住；受阻；無法繼續

It is figurative here.

Compare:

> **The car is stuck in the mud.**

> → 車陷在泥裡。

> **I'm stuck on this question.**

> → 我在這題卡住了。

The passage uses the second, **mental/problem-solving** sense.